MERMAID · BOTH FENCE CHARACTERS

# A tilde fence draws its diagram

CommonMark fences with backticks **or** tildes, and Markdown treats the two as the same thing. The live preview always did. The export did not — until this deck.

# What was wrong, and where

TILDE FENCES · A ~~~MERMAID BLOCK DRAWS ITS DIAGRAM ON BOTH PATHS

The CLI substituted an SVG for a backtick fence and nothing else, so a tilde fence printed as **raw source** in the PDF.

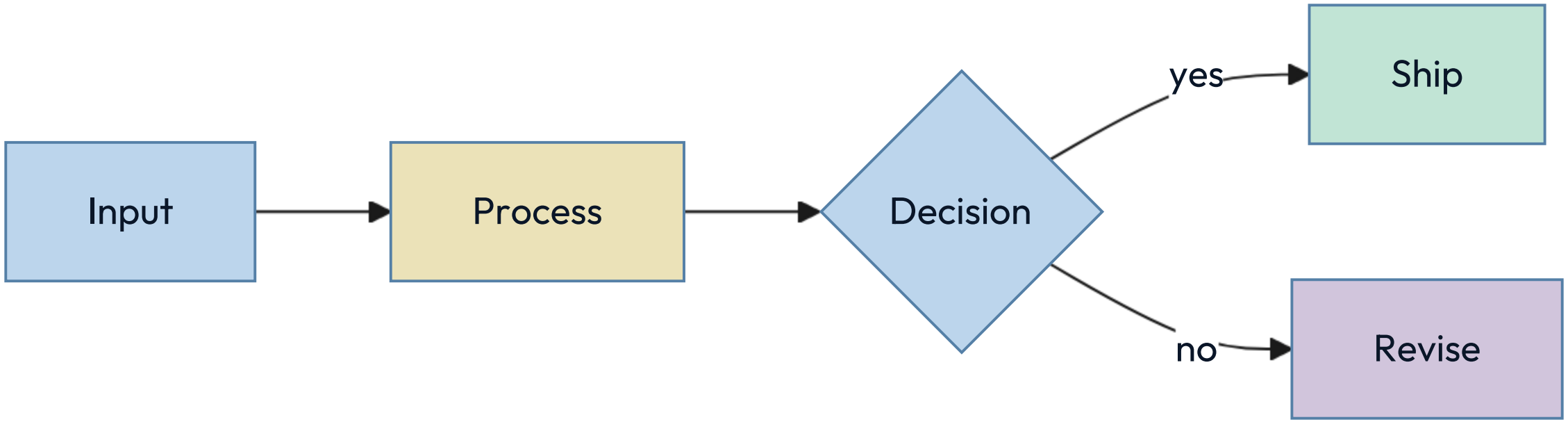
The author could not see it coming: the preview they wrote in renders both. The next two slides are one diagram, written two ways.

KEY INSIGHT

markdown-it emits `class="language-mermaid"` for either fence, and the runtime keys on that class.

# A backtick fence.

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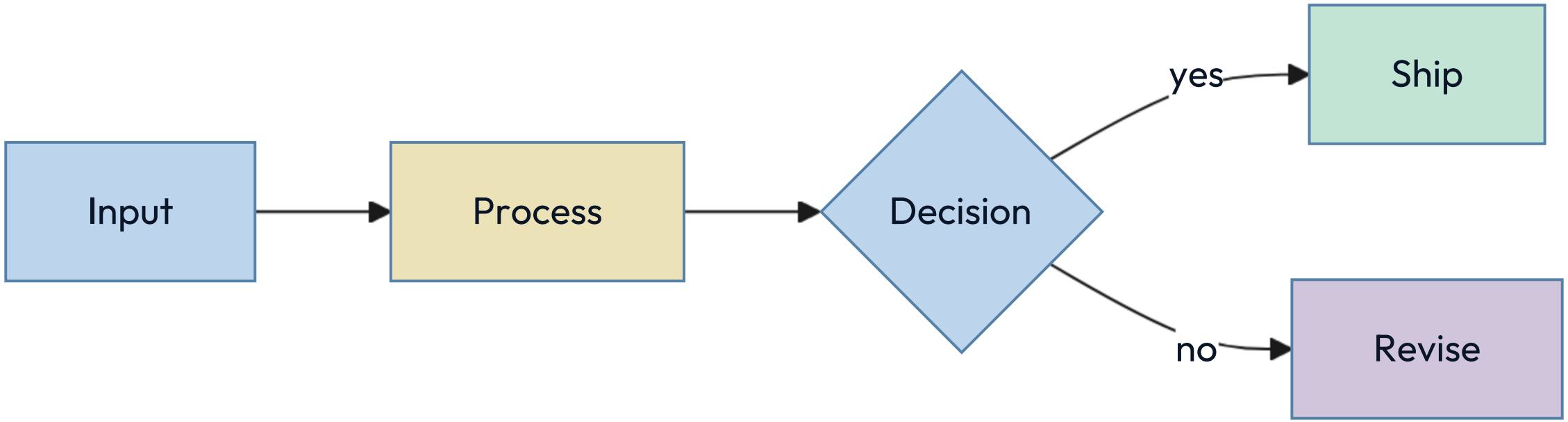



**KEY INSIGHT**

The form every deck in this repo already uses.

# A tilde fence.

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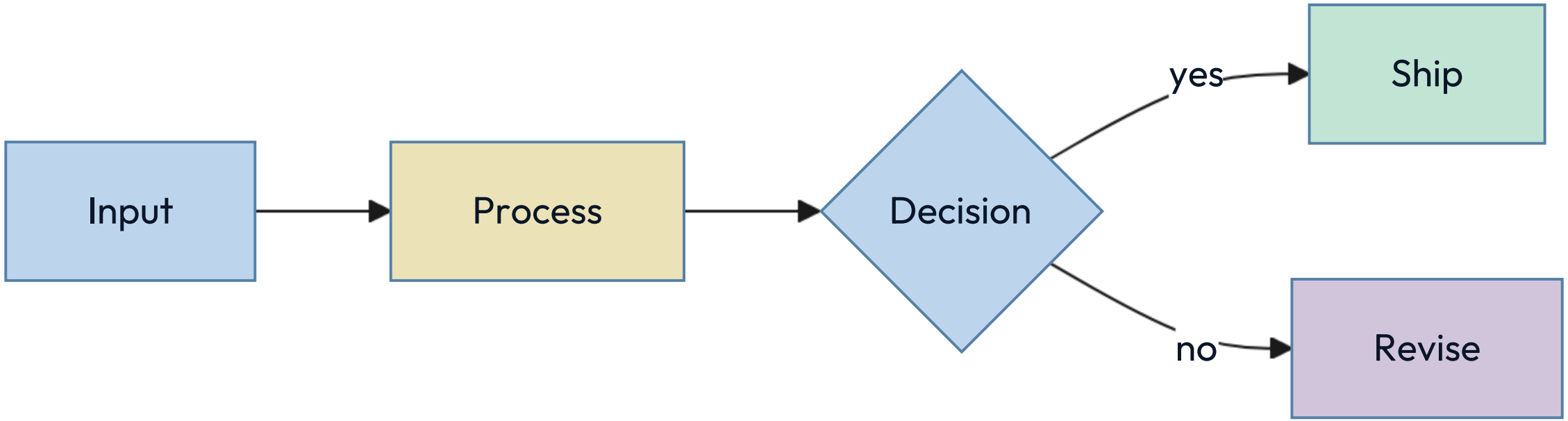

**KEY INSIGHT**

Identical bytes on the slide. Before this change, this page printed five lines of Mermaid source.

# A fence indented under a bullet.

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The flow this deck is about:



# Checked against what the engine draws

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Three spaces of indent is still a fence, so a diagram under a bullet draws. Four is a code block. A closer may outrun its opener. A fence inside a fence is a sample. A commented-out fence is not a fence.

KEY INSIGHT

Every one was a real export bug. The worst: an indented **closer** never closed, so one substitution ate two slide separators and a three-slide deck exported as a single page.

# One walker, and what it is allowed to move.

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**Both callers read it**

The CLI's substitution, and the narrator. Widen one alone and the voice cannot read the diagram.

**It walks lines, not a regex**

A closer may outrun its opener; a fence inside a fence is a sample. A regex got both wrong.

**No deck's bytes moved**

Measured across every tracked file: three docs changed, each already substituting its own example.